

Mingming Li

Department of Sociology · University of Innsbruck

Universitätsstraße 15, W2.23 · 6020 Innsbruck, Austria

Mingming.Li@uibk.ac.at · Personal website · Google Scholar · ORCID · LinkedIn

Research interests Gender inequality; STEM and educational stratification; work and labor markets.

EDUCATION

PhD candidate in Sociology, University of Innsbruck 09/2023–present

Dissertation Economic resources and the gender gap in STEM preferences and choices

Supervisor Wilfred Uunk. Expected completion March 2027.

MPhil in Economics, Central European University 09/2018–12/2021

Research on wage inequality and decomposition methods in the labor market.

MA in International Economy, Corvinus University of Budapest 09/2016–06/2018

Bachelor of Economics; Bachelor of Literature (dual degrees) 09/2012–06/2016

Wu Yuzhang Honors College, Sichuan University, Chengdu, China.

Majors in Economics and Journalism.

Exchange student, National Sun Yat-sen University 02/2015–07/2015

Department of Political Economy, Kaohsiung, Taiwan, China.

ACADEMIC APPOINTMENTS AND RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Visiting Scholar, LifBi, Bamberg, Germany 10/2025–01/2026

Leibniz Institute for Educational Trajectories. Host: Corinna Kleinert. Research on affluence and gender gaps in STEM choices in Germany.

Zhejiang University, Hangzhou, China 09/2022–09/2023

Institute of Common Prosperity and Development. Supervised by Li Shi and Guo Jiqiang. Led research on wage collective bargaining in Deqing; contributed to the Huzhou Common Prosperity Blue Book.

Hungarian Academy of Sciences, Budapest, Hungary 01/2021–12/2021

Human Capital Effects of Abortion Laws in Hungary (PI: Agnes Szabo). Policy analysis, model design, Stata programming, and manuscript writing.

RESEARCH FUNDING AND PROJECTS

Austrian Science Fund (FWF) research project 10/2023–09/2026

Research contribution to Affluence and the Gender Gap in STEM Study Choices.

PI: Wilfred Uunk. Grant P36789.

Principal Investigator, EPoS Young Scholar Research Funding (2026) 06/2026–06/2027

University of Innsbruck. Gendered Platform Work in China: Stigma, Algorithms, and Household Inequality.

Principal Investigator, EPoS Young Scholar Research Funding (2024) 06/2024–06/2025

University of Innsbruck. The Role of the Gig Economy in Gender Wage Gaps in China.

RESEARCH PAPERS AND PUBLICATIONS

* Corresponding author.

Gender, STEM, and Educational Stratification

Mingming Li*. “Does Affluence Widen the Gender Gap in STEM Choices? Micro-Level Evidence from Germany.” Submitted after major revision, *Social Science Research*.

- Mingming Li*** and Wilfred Uunk. “Economic Opportunity and the Formation of Gendered STEM Aspirations: Security, Returns, and Accessibility.” Under external review, *American Journal of Sociology*.
- Wilfred Uunk and **Mingming Li***. 2026. “Does Societal Affluence Increase the Gender Gap in STEM Graduation? A Longitudinal Assessment.” *Sex Roles* 92(3), 19. doi.org/10.1007/s11199-026-01654-1
- Mingming Li** and Maria Charles*. “From Housing Institutions to Gendered Fields of Study: The Educational Conversion of Institutional Advantage in Marketizing China.” Work in progress.
- Mingming Li*** and Wilfred Uunk. “Gendered Entry, Convergent Exit: Socialization, Labor Market Signals and STEM Educational Trajectories.” Under external review, *European Sociological Review*.
- Mingming Li*** and Wilfred Uunk. “Matching, Mismatch, and Exit: Gendered Realization of STEM Credentials in Urban China.” Major revision, *British Journal of Sociology of Education*.
- Mingming Li*** and Wilfred Uunk. “Assets beyond Housing and Gendered Entry into Science and Engineering among Homeowning Families in China.” With editor, *Sociological Perspectives*.
- Mingming Li***. “Macro-context associations with gender gaps in mathematics-related occupational aspirations vary by construct and geographic scale.” With editor, *Psychological Science*.
- Mingming Li**, Wilfred Uunk*, and Pia Blossfeld. “More College–College Couples Without a Stronger College Boundary? Population Composition and Parental-Education Sorting in China.” Work in progress.
- Lukas Arnold, Lukas Engelberger, Jonas Kamp, Liron Kol, Laura-Sophia Koller, **Mingming Li***, and Wilfred Uunk*. “Higher Education Lowers Science Skepticism, but Not When Status Is Inconsistent.” Work in progress.
- Jiangbo Li, Jun Cheng*, and **Mingming Li**. 2026. “Educational Authority in Digitally Mediated Filipino Transnational Families: Smartphones, Parenting, and Children's Learning Across Households.” *Family Relations*. Advance online publication. doi.org/10.1111/fare.70346
- Zheng Lu*, Wei Li, **Mingming Li**, and Yixuan Chen. 2019. “Destination China: International Students in Chengdu.” *International Migration* 57(3), 354–372. doi.org/10.1111/imig.12464

Gender, Work, and Labor Markets

- Tianhe Chen and **Mingming Li***. “Algorithmic Benevolent Sexism: Female Ride-Hailing Drivers and the Paradox of Protection in China.” Submitted after minor revision, *Sex Roles*.
- Tianhe Chen and **Mingming Li***. “Algorithmic Collaboration and Negotiated Dependence: Gendered Claim-Making and Platform Governance in China’s Ride-Hailing Sector.” Under external review, *New Technology, Work and Employment*.
- Mingming Li***, Xinyun Hu, Keyan Jin, and Jiachen Han. 2025. “Exploring factors influencing entry into the gig economy: A study of Chinese workers.” *Acta Psychologica* 259, 105301. doi.org/10.1016/j.actpsy.2025.105301
- Jiachen Han, **Mingming Li***, Shi Li, and Yingying Hu. 2024. “The widening gender wage gap in the gig economy in China: the impact of digitalisation.” *Humanities and Social Sciences Communications* 11(1), 1639. doi.org/10.1057/s41599-024-04172-1
- Xinyi Wei, Ru Jia, and **Mingming Li***. “Platform Access and Conditional Occupational Membership among Women Ride-Hailing Drivers in China.” With editor, *Work, Employment and Society*.
- Mingming Li** and Xinxin Ma*. “Flexible but Penalized? Gender Wage Gaps in China’s Informal Sector.” With editor, *Social Science Research*.
- Mingming Li** and Xinxin Ma*. “Employment Protection and Within-Couple Wage Inequality: Evidence from China.” With editor, *Journal of Family and Economic Issues*.

- Mingming Li***, Xinyun Hu, and Keyan Jin. 2025. “The Return on Education and the Gender Wage Gap in China: A Sector Perspective.” *SAGE Open* 15(2), 21582440251327015. doi.org/10.1177/21582440251327015
- Mingming Li***, Yuan Tang, and Keyan Jin. 2024. “Labor market segmentation and the gender wage gap: Evidence from China.” *PLOS ONE* 19(3), e0299355. doi.org/10.1371/journal.pone.0299355
- Mingming Li*** and Fumei Zhang. 2023. “The wage structure and gap between public and private sectors: an empirical study in urban China.” *Economic Research-Ekonomska Istraživanja* 36(2), 2106276. doi.org/10.1080/1331677x.2022.2106276
- Mingming Li***, Chunlu Tu, and Fumei Zhang. 2022. “Wage Gaps in Energy Industry: The Role of Sector.” *Frontiers in Energy Research* 10, 940637. doi.org/10.3389/fenrg.2022.940637
- Mingming Li*** and Jiayun Wang. 2021. “Influence of UTCP on the employment of female workers and the supply of labor force.” *PLOS ONE* 16(11), e0259843. doi.org/10.1371/journal.pone.0259843

Energy, Environment, and Development

- Chengying Yang, **Mingming Li***, and Dianyi Zhou. 2024. “Energy assessment in rural regions of China with various scenarios: Historical-to-futuristic.” *Energy* 302, 131894. doi.org/10.1016/j.energy.2024.131894
- Mingming Li**, Marko Milojevic, and Dmitry Gura*. 2024. “Development of methodology for evaluating sustainable rural development.” *Environment, Development and Sustainability* 26(8), 21237–21257. doi.org/10.1007/s10668-023-03526-0
- Xinyun Hu, Yanling Jiang, Pengfei Guo*, and **Mingming Li**. 2024. “How does China's big data policy affect the digital economy of cities? Evidence from national big data comprehensive pilot zones.” *Heliyon* 10(2), e24638. doi.org/10.1016/j.heliyon.2024.e24638
- Mingming Li***, Eugeny Kolpak, Pavel Zhukov, Gurgen Gukasyan, and Patricio Federico Lewis Zuñiga. 2023. “China’s Current Energy Policy: Dependencies and Contradictions.” *Polish Journal of Environmental Studies* 32(4), 3663–3672. doi.org/10.15244/pjoes/163564
- Pengfei Guo*, Xinyun Hu*, Shikuan Zhao, and **Mingming Li**. 2023. “The growth impact of infrastructure capital investment: the role of regional innovation capacity—evidence from China.” *Economic Research-Ekonomska Istraživanja* 36(2), 2142632. doi.org/10.1080/1331677x.2022.2142632
- Fang Su, **Mingming Li***, A. Shanthini, and R. Parthasarathy. 2021. “Systematic effective modeling and geospatial information framework for environmental issues in urban areas.” *Environmental Impact Assessment Review* 86, 106507. doi.org/10.1016/j.eiar.2020.106507
- Xinyun Hu and **Mingming Li***. 2020. “Ecopolitical discourse: Authoritarianism or democracy? — Evidence from China.” *PLOS ONE* 15(10), e0239872. doi.org/10.1371/journal.pone.0239872
- Zhigao Luo*, Xinyun Hu, **Mingming Li**, Jirui Yang, and Chuanhao Wen. 2019. “Centralization or Decentralization of Environmental Governance—Evidence from China.” *Sustainability* 11(24), 6938. doi.org/10.3390/su11246938

Additional Research

- Jun Cheng, **Mingming Li**, and Qinya Weng*. “A Multidimensional Measure of Psychological Traits Underlying Learning: Development and Validation.” Submitted after major revision, *BMC Psychology*.
- Mingming Li**, Nuo Xu, and Yue Liang*. 2026. “Social Reality as a Phenomenological Construct: Understanding Intersubjectivity through the Lens of Shared Meaning.” *Integrative Psychological and Behavioral Science* 60(1), 17. doi.org/10.1007/s12124-026-09987-y
- Nasi Wang and **Mingming Li***. 2026. “Teachers’ perceptions of the risks and benefits of AI in higher education: A case study of ERNIE Bot.” *Innovations in Education and Teaching International* 63(1), 318–330. doi.org/10.1080/14703297.2024.2432429

Xiaolong Shen, Jiangbo Li, **Mingming Li**, and Amir Karimi*. 2025. "A 29-Year (1994–2023) Bibliometrics Analysis of Usage of the Gamification in History Education." *European Journal of Education* 60(4), e70256. doi.org/10.1111/ejed.70256

Mingming Li* and Xinxin Xu. 2022. "Fertility Intentions for a Second Child and Their Influencing Factors in Contemporary China." *Frontiers in Psychology* 13, 883317. doi.org/10.3389/fpsyg.2022.883317

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Teaching Assistant, Central European University

Department of Economics and Business

Labor Economics (MA in Economics)	04/2021–06/2021
Trading and Portfolio Theory (MS in Finance)	09/2020–01/2021; 09/2021–12/2021
Asset Pricing (MS in Finance)	01/2021–04/2021
Investments I and II (MS in Finance)	09/2019–12/2019

School of Public Policy

Economic Analysis for Public Policy	09/2019–12/2019
-------------------------------------	-----------------

CONFERENCE AND SEMINAR PRESENTATIONS

Global GLO–JOPE Conference, Bonn, Germany (forthcoming)	11/2026–12/2026
121st Annual Meeting of the American Sociological Association, New York, USA	08/2026
International Gender & STEM Network Conference, Salzburg, Austria	07/2026
Economy, Politics & Society Summer Summit, Innsbruck, Austria	04/2026
10th International NEPS Conference, LIfBi, Bamberg, Germany	12/2025
LIfBi Colloquium, Bamberg, Germany	12/2025
16th European Sociological Association Conference, Porto, Portugal	08/2024
Ring-Seminar on Education, Family and Employment over the Life-Course, Trento, Italy	12/2023

ACADEMIC SERVICE

Academic Editor, PLOS ONE

01/2024–01/2025

Sociology; economics; gender studies.

Selected ad hoc reviewing Applied Economics; Applied Economics Letters; Asia Pacific Education Review; BMC Psychology; China & World Economy; Cogent Education; Economic Analysis and Policy; Economic Research-Ekonomska Istraživanja; Education Sciences; Global Environmental Change; Humanities and Social Sciences Communications; International Journal for Equity in Health; International Review of Economics & Finance; International Social Science Journal; Journal of Asian Economics; Labour and Industry; Marriage & Family Review; Mathematical Population Studies; PLOS ONE; Post-Communist Economies; SAGE Open; Social Sciences & Humanities Open; Studies in Higher Education; Telecommunications Policy.

FELLOWSHIPS AND AWARDS

CEU Doctoral Scholarship

09/2018–09/2021

Stipendium Hungaricum Scholarship

09/2016–09/2018

SKILLS

Research software Stata (proficient); Python, MATLAB, and SPSS (intermediate).

Office and typesetting Microsoft Word, Excel, and PowerPoint (proficient); LaTeX (intermediate).

Languages Chinese (native); English (proficient); German (beginner).